

Language And Society - 2

Introducing Sociolinguistics - suggested textbook
Rajend Mesthrie et al.

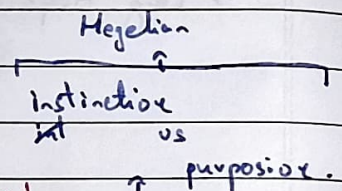
Language — Design Features (close enough) → Group of people who follow some linguistic norms

But what is society?

Aggregate of humans who structure their behaviours & share follow shared norms.

Communities $\subseteq$ Society

Norms of language use?



Sapir defines language as a purely human ^{and} ~~instinctive~~ ^{artificial} method of communication, ~~that~~ ^{voluntarily} produced symbols by a system of

Hunger is instinctive, eating is purposive
Need to communicate is instinctive, language (use) is purposive

Two streams of thought

(i) Pinker :- Language Instinct

(ii) Vyvyan Evans :- Language Myth.

Is competence purposive or instinctive?

~~Are we~~ Performance is instinctive says Pinker, Evans disagrees

Linguistic Competence vs Communicative Competence
↳ both are necessary to "know" a language.
↳ Chomsky does not include social competence.
↳ Autonomy of Syntax.
mental world of esoteric gymnastics

Classifying Societies:

Through hierarchical complexity. ← Also questioned.

But no language is more complex than the other. generally

On specific linguistic features, comparison is possible, but not a worthwhile comparison.

Language levels differences.

Homogeneity:-

No society or language is homogenous.

knows the language perfectly

Linguistic Theory is concerned with the ideal speaker-hearer in a completely homogenous speech community.

↳ unaffected by grammatically irrelevant conditions

Both premises are questionable constructs

↳ disfluencies

↳ sentences have to be well formed.

The task of a linguist is to get to this competence of this ideal speaker-hearer and describe it.

Their job does not concern with the usage of language.

Arm chair linguistics is dependent only on the linguist's intuition

↳ The Mentalist Approach / Generative linguistics:

The others were Structuralists. ← Usually missionaries

↳ Study the language - Write the grammar - Proselytize?

↳ Used informants → But doesn't record performative aspects

There was a need to look at socially situated performances.

↳ Different approach, need to account for variation.

Variability is intrinsic to language, needs to be studied systematically.

↳ not random hence can't ignore.

Types of Relationships

- 1) Social factors determine language patterns/behaviours
 - ↳ age, regional variations, gender

- 2) Linguistic structure also affects society

Hopi classifies nouns and verbs using duration

short ↗ long
↳ nouns ↳ verbs

Hopi has not noun-verb polysemy.

Bernstein :-

- ↳ Elaborate code :- formal, used for reasoning → Academia

- ↳ Restricted code :- Shortcuts, informal → Informal

Working-class children cannot access the ~~elab~~ elaborate code. Acc. to Bernstein

- 3) Bidirectional Bidirectionality — Dittmar (Marxist view of society)

- ↳ Dialectal relationship: Language and Society are not static. there is a churning b/w the twin.

No fixed linguistic or social structures. & Both are works in progress

- 4) Null Hypothesis — No relation b/w L & S ⇒ asocial linguistics
 - ↳ Chomsky !!

Sociolinguistics interfaces with anthropology, psychology, neurology, audiology, education, sociology

Literacy - Teaching people how to r/w is also political.

Questions of language standardisation.

Sociolinguistics and Sociology of Language are alternate views to the same matter.

↓ focus
language

↓ focus
society

Speech Communities:-

Community → group of people who believe that they belong to a common group.

Society → group of people who are (loosely) interdependent

Community → group of people who are (directly) interdependent

↳ Shared feeling / purpose / knowledge / ~~experience~~ aspiration / behaviour

↳ Identify with something

A speech / linguistic community with all the above features + language
Need not be a group of people speaking the same language, just need "one" common language.

Sharing a language != belonging to the same speech community (?)

Vice versa, speaking different languages != not part of common speech community.

Multilingualism is core to understanding speech communities

→ Eneneau

India as a Sprachbund - Different speech / language groups converge over time due to intermingling b/w different societies.

For example retroflexion, reduplication (partial-duplication)

Sociolinguistic areas ← Pandit:- Shared patterns of social behaviour, not language, sociolinguistic conventions that underlie all the different variants

↳ multilingualism is the norm ← centuries of mixing

↳ languages now have fn-al roles

↳ domains use of use

↳ shared speech norms = politeness etc.

Roger Bell - Sociolinguistics

- Different emphases on what constitutes a speech community
 - (i) Lyons → Shared language use
 - (ii) Bloomfield → frequency of interaction → density of comms.
 - (iii) Hymes → Shared rules of speaking (performance) and interpretation
Habitual contact, shared lang varieties & attitudes
 - (iv) Labov → Attitudes and values regarding linguistic forms and language use [What is prestige?]
 - ↳ We judge people by their speech, and have ~~other~~ attitudes towards these.
 - ↳ Accent to identify in monolingual communities (in multilingual communities asw, right?)

Speech Community vs. Lang Community - Roger Bell

- | | |
|--|--------------------------------------|
| ↓ | → |
| (i) Shared language and shared norms of language use | (i) Mainly sharing the same language |
| (ii) Focus on communication in social contexts | (ii) Focus on linguistic similarity |
| (iii) Includes speakers of diff. languages and share communicative norms | |

Communicative norms :- Pragmatics, how to speak, where & when - permissibility

Variations :-

Languages are made up of varieties

Hence they are social constructs

Hindi → [Marwadi, Awadhi] spectrum

Bangla → [Baulua, Chittagong]

↓
Baukua?

But Awadhi & Baulua are more similar to each other than to the others. Mythili is also very similar to these two.

Since language is a social construct, identification with a language is not dependent on linguistic criteria - ^{history, attitude} and politics. /əxomija/

Grierson found that Assamese & Bangla are very similar, yet Assamese people claimed a separate identity.

Take the case of Punjabi and Hindi. Arya Samaj promoted Hindi in Punjab, and Punjabi was relegated to the position of a dialect. On the other hand, the Sikhs identified ^{with} the script of Gurmukhi and that Punjabi was a separate language.

What about Hindi & Urdu? Are they the same or are they different?

Hindi & Urdu diverged from the common shared base of Hindustani. The languages are grammatically similar. Only major differences are ~~the~~ :-

दीदान - ए - बात or दादा - ए - आम

or दूत - ए - बू

This is called *hijasta* (?). The ^ए acts as the preposition of in English.

Post partition, Hindi is Sanskritized while Urdu is Persified. Hindi also uses the Devanagari script & Urdu uses the Perso-Arabic script.

This split began because of language, religion, region and identity.

The constituent assembly had the choice/question of which variant to standardise, and they chose the "pure" Sanskritised version of Hindi over Hindustani or Urdu, while Pakistan preferred Urdu.

Faiz (Ahmed Faiz)
↳ Revolutionary poet.
↳ शायर

/pojam/

classmate

Date _____

Page _____

Two identities - Islamic Identity - Bangladesh joined Pakistan
Linguistic Identity - Bangladesh turned independent.
These conflicted → Bangladesh wanted liberation

Kashmir? Urdu is official, but people speak Kashmir.
Hence people want Kashmiriyat (?) - identity as Kashmiri instead of Urdu (because of religion?)

Yugoslavia - Erstwhile Balkan country - language was Serbo-Croatian (split into Serbian & Croatian like Hindi-Urdu)
Serbian - Cyrillic; Croatian - Latin.
Croats claimed ethnic difference from Serbians - Civil War
- Split into multiple countries, Croatia claimed speaking a difference language.

Q China:- Cantonese & Mandarin - same script but mutually not intelligible.

Script itself is a marker of identity. ∃ no connection b/w language & script.
This identification of language and script is ~~ethnic~~ attitudinal, societal & extra-linguistic.

Meitei chose to ditch Bangla for a (reinvented) version of the Vishnupuri script.

Similarly, Bodo rejected the Assamese script for Devanagari instead

South Africa:- Zulu & Xhosa are mutually intelligible and structurally similar, but they are distinct languages.

Mutual Intelligibility:-

Salem? No! - Has a lot of Eddy Telugu tho? Why/How?

The boundaries are all political, for $\exists$ a continuum from the west to the east in India or even with accessible Malaysia & Tamil.

The language spoken in Chittagong is very similar to Burmese, but they are said to speak Bangla because they are part of Bangladesh.

→ not random

Variation:- If $\exists$ a language is used on a regular basis, then there is variation.

B Dimensions → conscious part of speaker's psyche

↳ Geographical:-

↳ Temporal (Diachronic study - Historical linguistics)

↳ Social

Language is organic because it exists in people's psyche, and these people are in society. Hence, language is always in flux.

↳ Idiosyncratic (Idiolect)

(i) Geographical Variation:-

The EIC / Raj conducted the first census in the late 19th century, but they were very wish-washy about the language question.

George Grierson held the first linguistic survey of India - 1894

He focused on the North Indian languages.

"Most Indian languages gradually merge into each other, not separated by hard & fast boundary lines"

Linguistic Continuum

Grierson chose a set of features and identified languages using these features (+/-)

Hired workers, chose the story of the prodigal son and made various language groups to translate it.

The English story was converted into 26(?) different clusters that was more intelligible to the natives. The natives then had to read the story and retell in their own idiosyncratic version.

Picked one story for it to be comparable.

The fieldworkers also asked the natives to tell tales not the Prodigal Son

He grouped villages into dialects and the dialects into languages

Example of a feature:- past participle ± l.

मार → मारा (Hindi) [+आ]

मार → मारिल (Assamese) [+इल]

मार → मारली (Bengali) (Bangla) [+इला]

मार → मारल (Bihari) [+अल]

Monolingual Dialectology in Europe

Political & Linguistic reasons

Junggrammatiker - Neo-grammarians

Crafted laws like Grassman's, Verner's, Jules' etc.

But to all these laws have exceptions.

Urbanisation → loss of rural forms → hence the need to study dialects.

Georg Wenker (1876)

b. School Teacher.

Created a questionnaire with 40 sentences. Sent it to headmasters of schools in Germany by post. Asked them to translate it into their variant. Resulted in 45,000 sentences → constructed an atlas of Germany (Sprachatlas des Deutschen Reichs) in 1881 → plotted linguistic variants in each area.

Jules Gillieron (1897-1901)

- ↳ Fieldwork like Grierson → Greengrasser
- ↳ Hired 'Edmond Edmont' because he had a keen ear for sounds
- ↳ Trained in phonetics.
- ↳ Gave him a cycle & sent him across French speaking lands → 639 locs.
- ↳ Online transcription by Edmont while the interlocutor was speaking
- ↳ Gillieron published the French Linguistic Survey in 1901

Hans Kurath (1939-43)

- ↳ LANE (Language Atlas of New England)

Trudgill & Chambers (1967-71)Problems:-

(i) Sample? → Surveyed

Edmond 'used' Nonmobile Old Rural Males [NORM]: only

(ii) Methodology?

Long questionnaires → chunks of data → also frozen

↳ Data is purely narrative, need not be dialect → may not capture the requisite variation
Attention then shifted from Geographical to Social Dialectology.

The notion of an isogloss:-

↳ a line drawn on a map that demarcates areas on the basis of linguistic features.

↳ could be lexical, phonological, morphological etc.

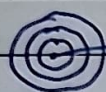
A bundle of isoglosses can be used to differentiate b/w dialects.

Dialects are defined by a bundle of isoglosses (1- impossible, 2- weak hypothesis, ... etc)

sectaphel is sheriffs

Hindi has isoglosses in the grammatical gender as well.
 देव, दुर्गा etc are female depending on the variant

Isoglosses can form patterns



— focal area. changes radiate outwards
 ↳ wave theory.

Non contiguous geographic areas can also share features
 ↳ relic areas.

For example; post-vocalic r in English.

Urban areas have migration from multiple → rural areas → dialect levelling & standardisation.

Transition Areas:-

Places on the isoglosses, where people use both variants interchangeably

Rheinisch Fan

Low German → p, t, k ← ich, machen, dorp, dat, appel, pund

High German → f, θ, x ← ich, machen, dorf, das, apfel, pfund

In the Rheinisch Fan (Cologne, Frankfurt, Mainz, etc) where both forms (fricatives / stops) are interchangeably used (but stops are preferred). Most Plosives → Most Fricatives ⇒ Cologne, Mainz, Frankfurt

This contradicts the Junggrammatischer thesis of change being clear and distinct.
 Verner's Law!

[]

↳ indicates a phonetic symbol.

Fischer (1954)

- ↳ studied 24 children in a village (in New England)
- ↳ Found that features like /-ɪŋ/ vs /-ɪŋ/ had ²¹ people using them variably
- ↳ Said that this was not random
- ↳ Showed that homogeneity in urban areas is a myth.
- ↳ This heterogeneity is structured - along certain social factors
 - ↳ sex, class, mood,

personality, formality, etc.

Found that girls preferred /-ɪŋ/ over /-ɪŋ/, so did children from rich families, cases of covert prestige & tense moods → /-ɪŋ/. Formal = /-ɪŋ/; Informal = /-ɪŋ/

This was the beginning of variationist sociolinguistics - Labovian linguistics / Social Dialectology

Labov:

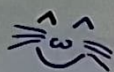
1963 - Martha's Vineyard

1966 - New York

1972 - Sociolinguistic Patterns

Steps

- i. Identify a linguistic feature - variation in the community
 - a. indicators - shows no social variation
 - b. markers - subject to style as well as social variation
 - c. stereotypes - faulty generalisations out stigmatised forms etc
- ♥ style - range ~~to~~ created by the amount of attention one pays to the speech generated >word list>
 - most attention - minimal pairs → passage to read - most formal (frozen)
 - careful speech (somewhere in the middle)
 - least attention - casual speech (aka the normal vernacular)



Sociolinguistics sociolinguists must study the vernacular.

The vernacular is the least normative.

↳ You can capture more variation

↳ Language change starts at the vernacular - hence important for studying change in focus.

Industrial Revolution 19th Century

Needed cheap labourers for plantations.

Exported Indian labourers to different parts of the world

Indentured labourers

The first people spoke the eastern dialects of Hindustani

1834 - first migration to Mauritius

39 - Guyana

45 - Trinidad & Tobago

60 - South America Africa

73 - Suriname

79 - Fiji

→ + -L

→ no -L

↳ temporal isogloss

Isoglosses can be synchronic or diachronic

Your cumulative position on the three scales

Education, Income, Occupation

Labov: speech varies across styles

No point in NORM for Urban settings

Socio Economic Status

We need a sample that is representative - age, gender, class

Identify a Topic to study

↳ Linguistic Variable that is frequent & enough

↳ Find minimal pairs to acquire normative data

↳ Sample properly

How do you sample the vernacular? Observer's Paradox

↳ Must divert the attention of the subject

↳ Danger of Death question → Emotionally charged

Labov's Harlem Expt
↳ class presentations

Harlem - Labov hired Black interviewers.

- ↳ Made people sit in a circle on the floor
- ↳ Interviewer acts like a learner
- ↳ Used curse & taboo words to minimise the social dist.

Anonymous Interview

- ↳ No recording
- ↳ Ask, hear & transcribe

Factor analysis - Which independent variable (or combination of variables) best explains the data

Power Analyses go brr.

Online Class !!

Social Variation:-

- Correlational / Labovian & Statistical: Correlation b/w linguistic & social variables
- Interactional Online class.

Correlational:- Fischer.

≠ an all or none feature for any of the features. Presence or absence is dependent on the various factors.

Labov:-

Set out a methodology - focus on sampling.

Society is stratified, generally along class (socio-economic status)

Then identification of various linguistic variables

- ↳ Indicator vs marker ↳ marks style and is a linguistic variable should be frequent & salient ↳ forecast to vernacular (self-consciousness)

The elicit good data → observer's paradox

- ↳ systematic observations ↗

Finally, correlate!

1 √ Ethnographic Model - ~1950s
2 Anthropologists and sociologists - Gumperz and Hymes - Interactional Model
3 √ SPEAKING - components of communication.
4 S - Setting and Scene - Where is the speech happening - time and place, concrete physical circumstances. Scene is an abstract psychological setting.
5 P - Participants - Those who are participating in the speech acts - addresser and addressee, speaker and hearer. Speech differs based on combination of speakers and hearers.
6 E - Ends - What are we trying to achieve - Goals, socially expected and personal.
7 A - Act Sequence - Actual form of the content spoken - What are the words used, how are they used, relation b/w what is spoken and the topic at hand etc. Each form has a different kind of language and topics that are afforded. (Pragmatics etc. ITL-2)
8 K - Key - Tone, Manner and/or Spirit - How is the message conveyed? Intonation, prosody. Like modal verbs in language, give speakers' intention. Paralinguistic and Kinesic cues as well. Listeners will attend to the Key rather than the Context while the Key doesn't match the expected one (Sarcasm).
9 I - Instrumentalities - Channels and Choice of Channels - Oral, written, telegraphic etc. We choose the register and the variant to use according to the medium of communication. Language use is bound by the conventions of the Instrumentality. Difference b/w Casual and Formal conversation. Instrumentality decides the code used.
10 N - Norms of Interaction and Interpretation - Different societies have different norms for what is socially accepted and what is not. Some communities are reticent, and some expansive. Body language, treatment of silence, returning of gaze, etc vary b/w social rules
11 G - Genre - Clearly demarcated type of utterance - Poetry, Editorials, Discourses, Sermons, etc are all examples. Depending on this, the nature of speech will differ. Overlaps significantly with the register. What is acceptable in one genre need not be acceptable in another. "Do not sermonise" etc.
12
13 Speaking is not Talking. You need skill and need to be sensitive to the components mentioned above then "Talk" doesn't happen.
14
15 Speech is just grammatical, good vocab, sentence constructions, etc. Ability to speak grammatically. No need to connect to anyone.
16 Talk is largely social, when we're able to connect to people in society. Talk is influenced by external factors - tied to performance.
17 Introspection? Not really talk.
18
19 One must have communicative competence to communicate through Talk
20

How to quantify linguistic variation

Martha's Vineyard: island off the east coast of the USA.

Populated by Native Americans, whites & Portuguese.

Lot of Mainland Americans come to the island for vacation.

LANE: - Linguistic Atlas of New England - Hans Kurath.

Found diachronic change ~~from~~ - diphthong centralisation

Historical trend to move ~~from~~ to $|aɪ|$ from $|aɪ|$; to $|aʊ|$ from $|aʊ|$

Back to Martha's Vineyard.

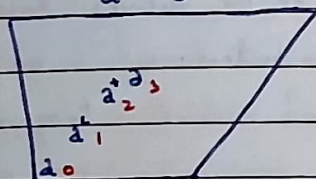
Stratification by age

Age	Index Score	usage of centralised (ɪ) diphthongs
75+	25	} Prestige forms of the mainland.
61-74	35	

46-60	62	} Do not like mainlanders - use for othering. Assertion of identity as Islanders by using $ə$ instead of a
31-45	81	
14-30	37	→ No development of identity yet, for social mobility.

Scoring

$a = 0$ $ə = 3$, middle sounds get fudged scores.



Diachronic linguistics does not deal with the process.

Sociolinguistics was a rebuttal to the Junggrammatiker Historical linguistics.

$[r]$ vs $[ɹ]$

~~as~~ $[θ]$ vs $[tθ]$ vs $[tʰ]$

Labov's New York Study - 1966. } along with $tʰ$

Post vocalic r is the variable. Class based stratification

0-1 score $\Rightarrow$ Lower Class; 2-4 $\Rightarrow$ working class (blue-collar);

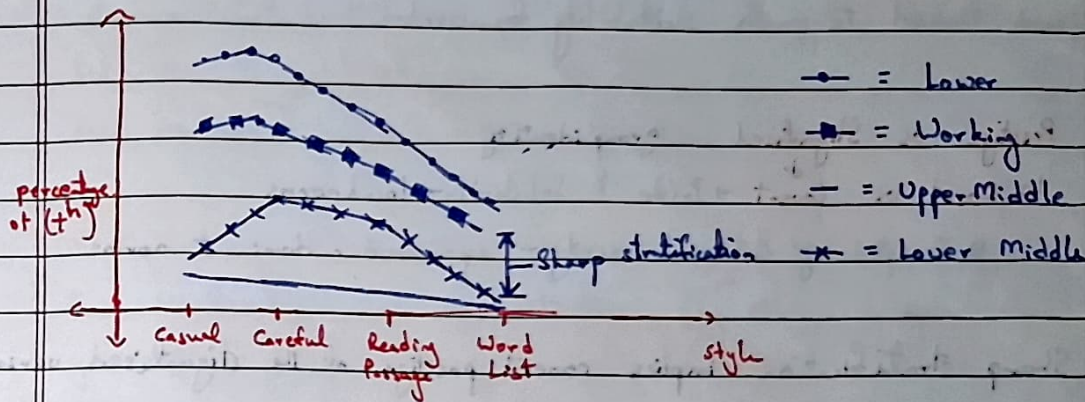
5-8 $\Rightarrow$ Lower Middle Class; 9-10 $\Rightarrow$ Upper Middle Class.

→ other variants

Prestige & Stigma variants

↳ accepted in the upper echelons of society

[tʰ] is most stigmatised, [θ] is most prestigious.



Language is a site for contestation

value

Indicators have no social features attached to it

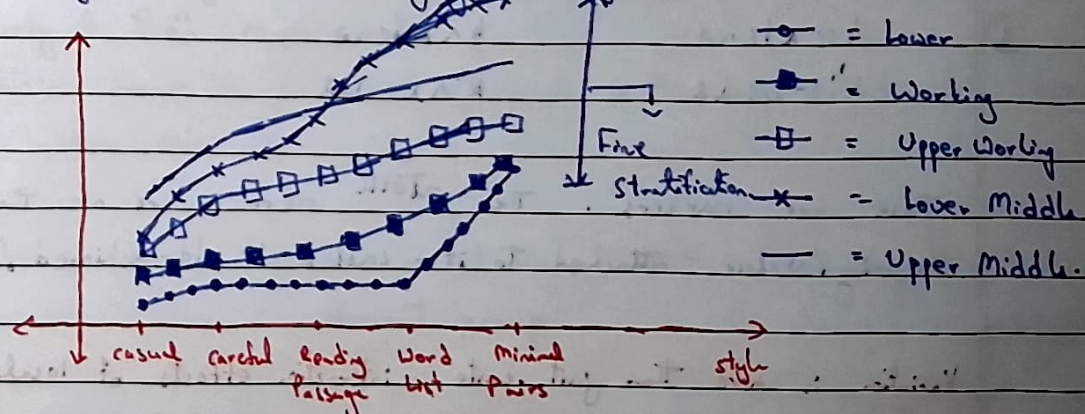
Markers are socially salient - show style shifting.

↳ the social value might be implicit.

Once the speakers become conscious of the social value - becomes a stereotype.

When there is a sharp stratification of society along one linguistic variable, the variable can get stereotyped.

Crossing over becomes highly unlikely



Lower Middle Class shows Hypercorrection - Linguistic Insecurity

Matched Guise Test:- Participants were presented with recordings of 22 sentences by the same person varying the post-vocalic 'r' and asked to rank suitability for work.

Prestige vs Stigmatised group identity

↳ Overt vs Covert → Pride & Solidarity - local norms

↳ Accepted by fashionable society - approved, dominant norms

Sharp stratification implies covert prestige of the stigmatised variant

>> overt prestige of the higher variation

Power vs Solidarity - Brown and Levinson? Who?

Caste Dialect Interactionist :- A. Gumperz - SPEAKING is one thing (ref online class)

1958 - Studied a village called Khelapur

↳ 2.5 years of interaction with the community

Studied the उत्तर , the cobblers/shoemakers → lived in the margins of the village.

Standard

Marginalised

①

bail

bail

dʒʰɪl

dʒʰɪl

②

kʊɾɐɳɐ

kʊɾɐɳɐ

kʰɪɾɐɳɐ

kʰɪɾɐɳɐ

These are markers. The उत्तर were aware of the social meaning/value attached to it - called it old-fashioned / low prestige

Variation is more than just caste, interaction effects of locality, age, education, social interaction

∴ $\exists$ no 1-to-1 correspondence b/w linguistic variables & social variables

Language Variation and Change

Junggrammatischer — change is initiated & applied without exception.

But this is not the case.

All changes ^{must} begin with a variation

Real Time vs Apparent Time:- Variation might take a lot of "real" time, instead of use apparent time (by studying people from different generations).

All variations need not lead to change.

Tense carrying words $\rightarrow$ finite; others $\rightarrow$ non-finite.

-ing going to -in orders in

progressive > adjective > gerunds > nouns.

Sociolinguistics are interested in variation leading to change.

To learn / find about the process of change.

Change from above and below:-

Above:- Change is initiated by people in the upper echelons of society & ~~high~~ ^{high} consciousness

Below:- Change is initiated by people in the lower echelons of society. Is unconscious.

Lexical borrowing from a variant/language that has higher prestige. Modelled after a dominant group.

It is claimed that women are more prone to initiating such a change.

Below :- Ease of articulation. Typical of the working classes.
Men drive this change apparently.

शुद्ध vs शुद्ध

Retention of Chhatti Chhattigari primer >> Retention of Hindi
primer in Chhattigari.

But over time, people lost nearly all of this literacy.

Concept formation happens best in the mother tongue.

Alienation from education system because of no exposure
to English prior to schooling.

Agency of the speaker in language change :-

1. Historical linguistics wouldn't care

2. Speaker-forcible linguists :- Historical, Prescriptivists, Chomskyan

asocial

↑

Innovation & Diffusions :- Innovations are idiosyncratic (usually) but
diffusion is conditional - Le Page says that it is social.

Papua New Guinea :- Lot of languages with distinct identities

One switches masculine & feminine gender around.

Similarly bin → huge for 'no'.

Ref Mesthrie.

How does diffusion occur?

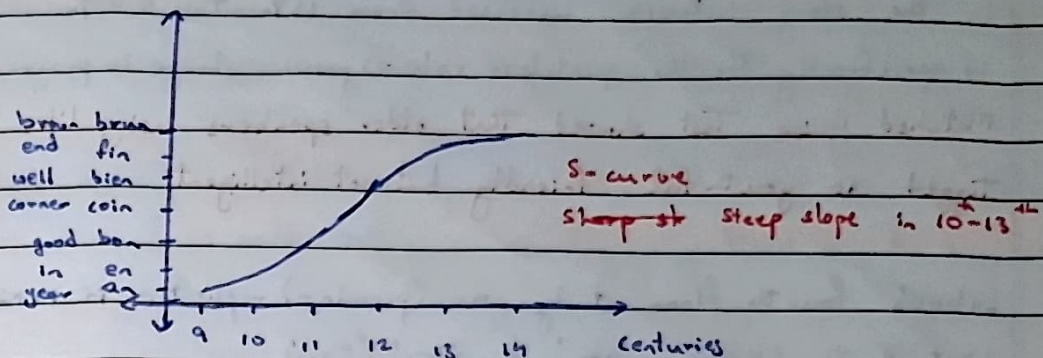
Compensatory lengthening :-

an̄čal → āčal

dante → dāt

pancha → pāch

Lexical Diffusion :- Travels word by / to word



n-dropping in French

Some environments are conducive for change, others not so much.
For example :- Rhoticity is more likely in post-vocalic positions than in pre-consonantal positions.

Age Grading

Change is age-graded.

- ↳ Apparent time → for change-in-progress
- ↳ Cross-sectional :- Take for language change. Sample subjects from diff ages. (aged asw. More feasible)
- ↳ Longitudinal :- For psycholinguistics. Study subjects across time
- ↳ Real Time ← Can stretch to centuries

However, it is not necessary that age graded differences will always indicate change. For example:- slang, flight of the clute ← Martin Jones

Slang - like :-

- ↳ Comparative :- like one's father } → linguistic fac.
- ↳ Verb :- I like ...
- ↳ Noun :- The likes

↳ Quotative :- I was like, "What"

↳ Hedge :- He was like super angry

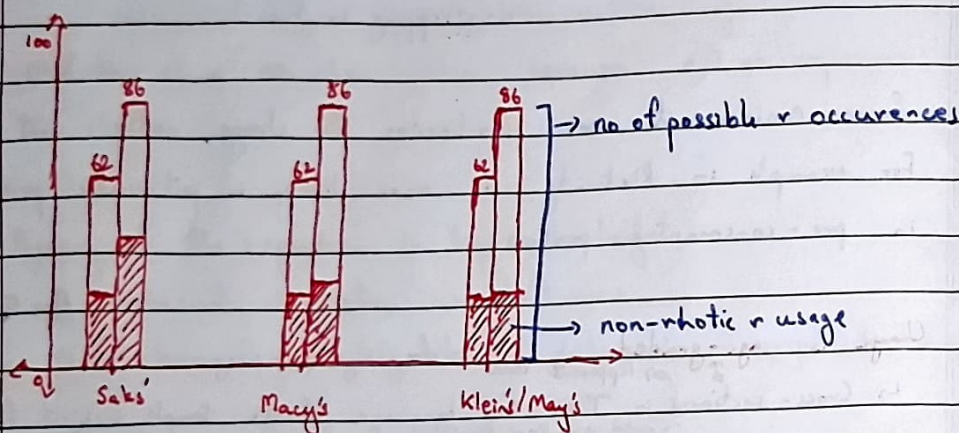
↳ Conjunctive ??

↳ Discourse Particle :- Draws attention to parts of the sentence

} → slang usage

Found that from 1995 to 2003/4, the % of usage of "like" in the slang instances increased from 13% to 58%
 ↳ specifically for the quotative role $\Rightarrow$ possible change in progress(??)
 Matched Guise Test showed that older speakers using like were tagged as youthful, friendly but not intelligent

Labov's fourth floor study was (pseudo-) replicated in 1986
 Went ~~to~~ to Macy's, Saks' & Klein's/May's



Labovian assumption:- Stigmatised Variants $\xrightarrow[\text{by}]{\text{rephud}}$ Prestige Variants

But it is seen that the stigmatised variants are maintained because of covert prestige & identity.

James & Leslie Milroy (Milroy & Milroy) (longitudinal & participant observation)
 Studied inner cities (poorer places) (ghettoisation) & rural areas in Ireland

Posited the existence of a network that is very important.

Network Density and Multiplicity

↳ Low Density = fewer inter personal connections

↳ High Density = many "

High Density $\rightarrow$ Linguistic Similarity

Plexity :- Multiplexity & Uniplexity :- How many ways do people know each other?

Multiplexity :- ~~How~~ many fns ; Uniplexity :- fewer fns.

High Density + Multiplexity $\Rightarrow$ closely knit social networks $\Rightarrow$ social ties are stronger. $\Rightarrow$ norm setting $\leftarrow$ usually stigmatised variants because of covert prestige and solidarity

Language Change

logic for maintenance of non-prestige variants